

**NAME OF SCHOOL: MATER MISERICORDIAE SECONDARY SCHOOL,
RUMOMASI**

TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: SEVEN

CLASS: SS2

SUBJECT: Government

TOPIC: Local Government Administration

Introduction

- Local government is the third tier of government in Nigeria — the grass-root level closest to the people. The 1976 local government reforms standardised it: 774 local government areas today, each with an elected chairman and councillors.

Functions of local government

- Collecting rates, licences and fees; constructing and maintaining roads, drains, parks and markets; primary education (now partly federal/state); primary health care and clinics; sanitation and waste disposal; registration of births, deaths and marriages; agricultural extension support; and providing community development.

Structure

- The chairman (executive head), the legislative council (the councillors), the local government secretariat (departments: administration, finance, works, health, education, agriculture), and traditional rulers who advise. Revenue comes from statutory allocations (from the federation account), internally generated revenue, and the state's share.

Problems

- Inadequate finance and dependence on allocations; corruption and mismanagement; poor staff training; political interference by the state; the denial of autonomy; and the inability to provide services. Reforms seek financial autonomy (the Supreme Court ruling of 2024 on direct allocations).

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Define local government.
2. List five functions of local government.
3. State the sources of local government revenue.
4. Mention three problems facing local governments.

**NAME OF SCHOOL: MATER MISERICORDIAE SECONDARY SCHOOL,
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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: EIGHT

CLASS: SS2

SUBJECT: Government

TOPIC: Nigerian Colonial History

Introduction

- Colonial rule in Nigeria began with the British annexation of Lagos in 1861 and the establishment of the protectorates, and ended with independence in 1960. It changed Nigeria's political, economic and social life profoundly.

Stages of colonisation

- The missionaries and traders came first (the Royal Niger Company); the Berlin Conference (1884–85) formalised the partition of Africa; the amalgamation of the Northern and Southern protectorates took place in 1914 by Lord Frederick Lugard. Britain ruled through indirect rule — governing through the traditional chiefs and emirs.

Political legacy

- The colonial state created Nigeria's boundaries (arbitrarily drawn), the central bureaucracy, the judiciary, and a new educated elite; but it also divided the country into regions (North, East, West), promoted ethnic separateness through indirect rule, and left a centralised, expensive administration. The colonial economy was built for export (palm oil, cocoa, groundnut, tin) and the importation of manufactures — a pattern that persists.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. When was Nigeria amalgamated and by whom?
2. What is indirect rule?
3. State two political legacies of colonial rule.
4. How did the colonial economy shape Nigerian trade?

**NAME OF SCHOOL: MATER MISERICORDIAE SECONDARY SCHOOL,
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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: NINE

CLASS: SS2

SUBJECT: Government

TOPIC: Nigerian Nationalism

Introduction

- Nationalism is the struggle for self-government — the movement for independence. Nigerian nationalism grew from the educated elite, the press, the trade unions, the youth movements and the political parties.

The movement and its leaders

- Early stirrings: the Aba women's riot (1929) against taxation; the Nigerian Youth Movement (1936); the press (Herbert Macaulay, Nnamdi Azikiwe — 'Zik of Africa'); the trade unions (Michael Imoudu); and the pan-African ideas of the era. Leading nationalists: Herbert Macaulay, Nnamdi Azikiwe, Obafemi Awolowo, Ahmadu Bello, J.S. Tarka, Anthony Enahoro, Fummilayo Ransome-Kuti, Tafawa Balewa.

Factors that aided nationalism

- Western education and the educated elite; the Second World War (returning soldiers and the Atlantic Charter); the exploitation of the colonial economy; the growth of the press and radio; pan-Africanism and the independence of Asian countries (India, Ghana in 1957); and the formation of political parties — the NCNC (1944), the Action Group (1951) and the NPC (1951).

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Define nationalism.
2. Name four Nigerian nationalists.
3. Mention three factors that aided nationalism.
4. Which constitution gave Nigeria internal self-government in the regions? (The 1954 Lyttleton Constitution.)

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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: TEN

CLASS: SS2

SUBJECT: Government

TOPIC: Independence & The First Republic

Introduction

- Nigeria became independent on 1 October 1960 and a republic in 1963. The First Republic (1960–1966) was marred by regional tensions and ended in the first military coup in January 1966.

The road to independence

- Self-government came in 1957 (the North in 1959); the 1960 independence was achieved through constitutional conferences (London 1957, 1958); Sir Abubakar Tafawa Balewa became the first Prime Minister; Dr Nnamdi Azikiwe the first Governor-General (and first President after 1963); and Dr Obafemi Awolowo the leader of opposition.

The First Republic

- A federation of three regions (North, East, West; the Mid-West created in 1963); a parliamentary system (the Prime Minister and cabinet); the Westminster model with the Governor-General representing the Queen. Regional politics were tense: the census dispute of 1962–63, the Western Region crisis (the Action Group's 1962 crisis), the Tiv riots, the 1964 federal election crisis and the 1965 Western election's 'operation wetie' violence.

Fall of the Republic

- The January 1966 coup (led by Nzeogwu and others) overthrew the government, killed the Prime Minister, and ended the First Republic. Causes of instability: regionalism, ethnicity, rigged elections, corruption and the struggle for power.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. When did Nigeria become independent and a republic?
2. Name the first Prime Minister and the first President.
3. Give two causes of the crises of the First Republic.
4. What event ended the First Republic?

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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: ELEVEN

CLASS: SS2

SUBJECT: Government

TOPIC: The Coups & Military Rule (1966–1999)

Introduction

- Nigeria spent about 30 of its years since independence under military rule (1966–1979, 1983–1999). The coups and counter-coups, the civil war, the oil boom, and the return to democracy in 1999 define this period.

The coups

- January 1966 — the first coup (majors Nzeogwu and others); July 1966 — the counter-coup (Lt. Col. Yakubu Gowon emerged); and the civil war (1967–70). Gowon ruled until 1975 (the anniversary syndrome), then Murtala Mohammed (1975–76, killed in the Dimka coup); Olusegun Obasanjo (1976–79) handed over to Shagari (the Second Republic); the 1983 coup (Muhammadu Buhari); the 1985 coup (Ibrahim Babangida, who annulled the 1993 election — the June 12 crisis); the interim government of Ernest Shonekan (1993); and Sani Abacha (1993–1998); Abdulsalami Abubakar (1998–99) returned power to democracy on 29 May 1999.

Achievements and failures

- Achievements: the creation of states (from 4 regions to 36 states), the Federal Capital Territory (Abuja), the civil war victory and 'no victor, no vanquished', the Nigerianisation of the civil service, development projects (the oil era), and the eventual return to democracy. Failures: corruption, the annulment of June 12, human rights abuses, poor governance, and the stagnation of many institutions.

The Second Republic (1979–1983)

- The 1979 Constitution (the American presidential model) and Shehu Shagari's NPN government; the 'politics of money' and rigging; the collapse of the economy (the oil glut); and the 1983 coup under Buhari — the end of the Second Republic.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. List three Nigerian coups and their leaders.
2. Who annulled the June 12, 1993 election?
3. How many states were created? Name the current number.

4. State one achievement and one failure of military rule.

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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: TWELVE

CLASS: SS2

SUBJECT: Government

TOPIC: The Second Republic (1979-1983) & Return to Democracy

Introduction

- The military handed power back to civilians in 1979, creating the Second Republic — a full replica of the American presidential system. It collapsed in 1983, and democracy returned only in 1999. This week studies the period.

The 1979 Constitution

- The constitution adopted the American presidential model: an executive president (elected separately, the head of state and government), a National Assembly (Senate and House of Representatives), an independent judiciary, separation of powers and checks and balances, a two-term limit, and the federal character principle — designed to distribute offices and calm ethnic tension.

The 1979 and 1983 elections

- The 1979 elections produced Alhaji Shehu Shagari (NPN) as president — after the famous interpretation of the '25% in two-thirds of the states' requirement by the Supreme Court; the NPN won the federal centre with its 'politics of ethnic arithmetic' (the NPN–NPN–NPN 'north–south balancing'). The 1983 elections were marred by rigging — the massive, open manipulation that destroyed the credibility of the republic.

The fall of the republic

- The economy collapsed (the oil boom ended — the 1982 world oil glut); salaries were not paid; corruption grew openly; the rigged 1983 elections alienated the people; and on 31 December 1983, General Muhammadu Buhari overthrew the government in a coup — the Third Republic never emerged; General Babangida's annulment of the June 12, 1993 election and the military rule of Abacha (1993–1998) followed, and democracy returned in May 1999 with President Olusegun Obasanjo.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. What constitution created the Second Republic?
2. State three features of the 1979 Constitution.

3. Who won the 1979 presidential election?
4. Why did the Second Republic collapse?
5. When did democracy return to Nigeria?